[Metric-SI]
AA-C-00556E (GSA-FSS)
July 1, 1993
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. AA-C-556B
May 26, 1952

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION
COSTUMER, WOOD, GENERAL OFFICE

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification AA-C-556B dated May 26, 1952.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification describes a general office wood costumer. All measurements are in metric (SI) units. Dimensions are in millimeters (mm).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and sizes. The wood costumer shall be of one type and one size. It shall be knockdown (KD) construction.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids, or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Available from Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Ave., Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

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American Society for Testing and Materials Standards:

ASTM D 905 - Standard Method of Test for Strength Properties of Adhesives in Shear by Compression Loading.
ASTM D 1211 - Temperature-Change Resistance of Clear Nitrocellulose Lacquer Films Applied to Wood

(ASTM Standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Regulatory requirement. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

3.2 Materials. The following paragraphs describe minimum requirements for materials used in construction and assembly.

3.2.1 Wood, wood products.

3.2.1.1 Wood varieties. Wood parts shall be of the kinds listed in table I and of the quality hereinafter specified. Only one species shall be used throughout a single unit.

TABLE I - Wood Varieties

Beech
Birch
Cherry
Hackberry
Maple
Red Alder
Southern Magnolia
Sweetgum

3.2.1.2 Solid wood parts. Wood shall be bright, well sanded, and free from brashness, discolorations, worm holes, honeycomb, splits and shake, except that a few small burls, pin knots not exceeding two per square foot average, mineral streaks not exceeding 1.5 mm by 100 mm, or 3 mm by 50 mm in area and averaging not more than one per square foot will be permitted.

3.2.2 Adhesive. Wood joinery and HPL adhesive: Average block shear strength, 19 300 kPa minimum. See test procedure par. 4.6.2.

3.2.3 Hardware.

3.2.3.1 Glides. Glides shall be nail type, minimum 32 mm diameter, rubber cushioned with oxidized copper finish.

3.2.3.2 Hooks. Hooks shall conform to the following requirements:

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a. Die cast zinc alloy, cast true, free from blow holes or other defects.
b. Bronze or brass plated with bright satin finish, 0.0005 mm thick min.
c. Upper hook shall support an 355 kg load applied over the knob.
d. Lower hook shall support a 53 kg load applied over the knob.
e. Shall be secured with a minimum of two No. 8 x 19 mm oval-head brass or bronze plated screws.

3.2.3.3 Tapered connector. Connector shall be cold rolled steel and minimum 100 mm long. Attach with minimum M-4 (No. 8) x 19 mm screws in post and minimum M-4 x 30 mm screws in legs. Known source of supply is listed in 6.3.

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Design. The design and construction of the costumer shall be as illustrated in figure 1 and as specified herein.

3.3.2 Components. Costumer components shall consist of a pole, four leg members (with tapered connectors attached), four glides (3.2.3.1), four hooks (3.2.3.2) and fasteners.

3.3.4 Assembly. The pole and legs shall be shipped KD.

3.3.5 Assembly instruction sheet. The manufacturer shall prepare an instruction sheet with simple illustrated assembly directions. It shall be available for use and approval at the time of the preproduction inspection. The approved assembly instruction sheet shall be package with each unit.

3.3.6 Overall dimensions. The overall dimensions shall be 1675 mm by 610 mm square at the base.

3.3.7 Component tolerances. All wood parts shall be carefully cut to insure an accurate fit and easy assembly with the following tolerances maintained that provide a tight, rigid unit when assembled.
Overall dimensions: $\pm$ 6 mm
Dimensions of any wood part: + 4, - 2 mm.

3.3.8 Pole. Pole shall be made one solid piece or laminated of up to three full length/width pieces of wood (3.2.1.1). The top 9 mm of the pole shall be beveled on a 45 degree angle on all four sides. The wide portion of the tapered connectors shall be securely screwed to each of the four faces of the pole as shown in figures 1 and 2. Four hooks shall be mounted to the pole in the positions shown in figure 1.

3.3.9 Legs. Leg members shall be shaped as shown in figures 1 and 2. The legs shall be made of solid or built-up stock. The narrow portion of the tapered connectors shall be attached to

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each leg member. Legs shall be grooved to receive the tapered connector as shown in figure 2. The connectors shall be located so that when the costumer is assembled, the bottoms of the legs and post align evenly and join tightly together.

3.4 Wood finishing.

3.4.1 Color and finish. The wood finish shall match the standard walnut laminate sample FSS-L-01002 in color only (see 6.3). Grain appearance may vary depending on the wood used. The natural grain of the wood shall not be clouded by the finishing materials. Bleaching agents or materials shall not be used. The application of materials drying time, sanding, cleaning and rubbing shall be controlled to produce items of uniform finish without sags, runs, orange peel or other defects detrimental to a smooth quality appearance. Final finish shall be satin. Finish shall meet test requirements in 4.6.1.

3.4.2 Recommended procedure for finishing exposed wood surfaces.

1. Wood components of the costumer shall be sanded smooth with corners and edges eased.
2. Sap stain to equalize wood color.
3. Apply selected stain to wood to produce color specified.
4. Wash coat with adhesive sealer. Sealer shall withstand toughness and adhesion test specified in 4.6.1.
5. Scuff sand, using fineness of sandpaper grit needed to produce proper surface.
6. Seal with adhesive sealer.
7. Sand, using fineness of sandpaper grit needed to give proper surface.
8. Shade to tie in color variation, if necessary.
9. Top coat with two coats of lacquer.
10. Rub, Steel wool, wax or polish, as required, to a satin finish.

Note: No. 8 may be performed where shown or after No. 5.

3.5 Identification marking. Each unit shall be permanently and clearly marked with contrasting ink in an inconspicuous place, with the National Stock Number, contract number, this specification number, the month and year of manufacture, and the manufacturer's name or trademark.

3.6 Workmanship.

Machining: Accurately accomplished without tearout or other defects.

Joinery: Tight, even, securely glued/screwed. Loose or open joints are not permitted.

Construction: Accurately and squarely assembled without gaps. Filling to cover up poor machining/assembly is not permitted. Excess glue shall be removed.

Sanding: All surfaces exposed to view in normal use, including drawer parts, shall be smoothly sanded.

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Edges/corners: Units shall be free of splinters, sharp edges, and sharp corners to prevent injury to personnel or damage to their clothing.

Finishing: The natural grain of the wood shall not be clouded by finishing materials. The application of finishing materials, drying time, sanding, cleaning, and rubbing shall be controlled to produce items with uniform finish without sags, runs, orange peel, overspray, or other defects detrimental to a smooth, quality appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that the supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article inspection and testing. The required samples shall be inspected and tested by the contractor for all the requirements of the contract. A record of this inspection and test, including certificates of conformance for materials, shall be submitted to the government for approval. The Government reserves the right to witness the contractor's inspection and tests.

The sample required for first article inspection and testing shall be examined and tested for all the requirements of this purchase description. The first article samples shall be manufactured in the same manner, using the same materials, equipment, processes, and procedures as used in regular production.

All parts and materials, including packaging and packing, shall be obtained from the same source of supply as used in regular production. Use first article samples as manufacturing standards. Manufacturer shall maintain first article samples until the last order is shipped, received, and accepted. New first article samples are required for each new contract. Old first article samples shall not be reused.

4.3 Lot acceptance tests. Lot acceptance tests shall be conducted under the supervision of the Government Inspector at the manufacturer's plant. In the event the manufacturer does not have the facilities to perform the required tests, he shall engage the services of a commercial testing laboratory acceptable to the Government. Copies of the laboratory report shall be submitted to the Government Inspector upon receipt from the laboratory. All examination and testing shall be in accordance with Section 4 of this specification.

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4.4 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.5 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's). Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as shown in TABLE II.

TABLE II.
Acceptable quality levels in accordance with MIL-STD-105

For examination in	Inspection level	Major	Total
4.5.1	II	4.0	6.5
4.5.2	S-2		4.0
4.5.3	S-2		4.0
4.5.4	S-2		4.0

4.5.1 Visual examination. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classification of defects specified in TABLE III and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) specified in 4.5 herein. The lot size shall be all units of the same type offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit for this examination shall be one complete item.

TABLE III Classification of defect

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Wood material	Species of wood in any wood component not as specified.	X	
	Split, shake, or check over 50 mm in length.	X	
	Decay over 6 square mm in area in any component.	X	
	Split, shake, or check up to and including 50 mm in length which may affect serviceability.		X
	Loosened grain, torn grain or chip-out which may affect serviceability.		X
	Area over 100 square mm not smoothly surfaced.		
	Honeycomb.	X	

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TABLE II Classification of defect (cont.)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Wood (Cont'd)	More than two exposed pin knots per square foot average.		X
	Loose knot.	X	
	Knot greater than 3 mm diameter.	X	
	Glue line opening in edge glued or built-up stock over 25 mm in length.	X	
	Sapwood or mineral streak which may affect serviceability or strength.	X	
	Undesirable wood defect filled in with plastic wood or other filling compound.		X
Construction and workmanship	Wood component missing.	X	
	Loose or unsound joint.	X	
	Joint open more than 1 mm or 60 percent around its perimeter.		X
	Evidence that glue at joint or block has not been applied where required.	X	
	Hooks not securely tightened.		X
	Taper connectors are not positioned as specified	X	
	Legs do not fit tightly to the post	X	
	Wood member improperly positioned or not positioned as specified.	X	
	Wood member warped, cupped, or twisted out of specified shape.	X	
	Shape or contour of wood member not as specified.		

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TABLE II Classification of defect (cont.)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Construction (Cont'd)	Wood not full length piece where required.	X	
	Unit does not assemble readily.	X	
	Assembly instruction sheet missing.	X	
Finish and appearance of exposed wood parts visible in normal use position.	Does not match standard reference panel with respect to color, texture, and gloss.	X	
	Discoloration (Bleeding) over 25 square mm in area.		X
	Spotted, affecting appearance.		X
	Light or dark colored areas, affecting appearance.		X
	Area of no lacquer or varnish film over 25 square mm in area.	X	
	Glue stain or glue line clearly showing, affecting appearance.		X
	Excess glue not removed.		X
	Finish peeling, flaking, blistered, cracked, checked or wrinkled.	X	
	Finish cut or rubbed through to wood.		X
	Open grain. Finishing material not filling pores.		X
	Orange peel, affecting appearance.		X
	Damage or scratch less than 25 mm long or 25 mm square.		X
	Damage or scratch over 25 mm long or 25 mm square.	X	
	Finish tacky, i.e., not completely dry.		X

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TABLE II Classification of defect (cont.)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Finish (cont'd)	Rough or gritty surface or foreign matter imbedded in finish.		X
	Light colored edge not touched up.		X
	Burn-in or repairs not neatly accomplished.		X
	Unstained (white) wood visible when item is in normal use position.		X
	Not polished where required.		X
Hardware Finish	Hat and coat hook corroded.		X
	Not finish specified.		X

4.5.2 Examination of assembly. Costumers unassembled for KD shipment shall be selected from each inspection lot, assembled and examined in accordance with the defects specified in Table IV. KD costumers shall be assembled to insure that the individual parts will intermember and be easily assembled. Acceptable quality levels (AQL's) are specified in 4.5 herein. The lot size shall be all units of the same type offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit for this examination shall be one complete item.

(Note. Unassembled costumers, selected by the Government inspector, shall be fully assembled by the contractor. The inspector shall witness the assembly of the legs to the pole and shall observe the ease of assembly and fit of components.)

TABLE III Visual defect of assembly

Examine	Defect
Assembly	Requires special tools for assembly. Not easily assembled, i.e. requires modification, excess force or enlargement of hole.
Instructions	Missing, illegible, or incorrect.

4.5.3 Dimensional examination. Any dimension not within tolerance specified shall be classified as a defect. Acceptable quality levels (AQL's) are specified in 4.5 herein. The lot size shall be all units of the same type offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit for this examination shall be one complete item.

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4.5.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. Examination of preparation for delivery shall be in accordance with acceptable quality levels (AQL's) are specified in 4.5 herein. The examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation. Closed shipping containers shall be examined for closure defects. The lot size shall be expressed in number of shipping containers.

TABLE IV. Preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior).	Incorrect; incomplete; illegible; omitted; size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials.	Any nonconforming component; component missing, damaged or otherwise defective.
Workmanship.	Inadequate application of components: such as incomplete closure of container, loose or inadequate sealing, strapping or stapling; bulged or distorted container.

4.6 Tests. Perform all tests at first article inspection and again one year after the start of the schedule contract period. Perform finish tests 4.6.1(d) once a month during the contract period. On contract with an option year(s), rerun all tests after the first, second etc. year(s). Failure to meet test requirements may be cause for rejection.

4.6.1 Finish test requirements. (See 3.4.1) The following tests (except UV test) shall be performed on a sample panel finished in the same manner as units are finished in production.

All test panels shall be produced from finish materials currently being used in production. All samples tested shall meet the following test requirements. Actual test results are required. Certifications are not acceptable.

(a) Cold check. Age panel one week. Follow ASTM D 1211 test procedure. After exposure of 10 cycles, there shall be no checking or cracking. True film checking is one or more wavy or straight lines which cross the grain and do not appear related to grain structure. When a panel displays veneer checks, check running parallel to the grain, or glue line fracture, the panel shall be disregarded and another panel tested.

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(b) Cold print. Age panel 48 hours. A 50 x 50 mm (approx.) piece of duck material (canvas) 280 g/m^2, minimum count of 23.6 x 22.8 yarns per cm, shall be placed on the panel. Place a 455 g weight on the material for 24 hours at 24 degrees C. Bottom (contact surface) of the weight shall be flat and have a 28 mm diameter. After the weight is removed, light polishing with a soft cloth and liquid polish must remove any imprint.

(c) Ultra violet light resistance. Spray one-half of a 150 mm x 230 mm white porcelain panel with two coats of the lacquer to be tested. Allow panel to air dry for at least 18 hours. Place panel 305 mm from an ultraviolet light (Uviarc 420-U1 light with UA-3 lamp) with a 3.18 mm thick pane of window glass placed between the lamp and the panel, and expose for 24 hours. After exposure, spray the other half of the panel in the same manner and allow to dry for at least 4 hours. Compare the two finishes. There shall be no more than a slight darkening of the UV light exposed film when checked under cool white fluorescent light.

Uviarc 420-U 1 light and UA-3 lamp are available from George W. Gates Co., Inc., P.O. Box 216, Franklin Square, Long Island, NY.

(d) Toughness and adhesion. Perform test for toughness and adhesion on a sample panel finished in the same manner as the furniture using Organic Coating Adhesion Tester, Model No, 1001 in accordance with manufacturer's instructions. Mar the panel both parallel and perpendicular to the grain. Film must conform to resulting indentation. Whitening (film separation) or cracking is not acceptable.

Organic Coating Adhesion Tester Model No. 1001 is available from U.S. Testing Company, Inc. Instrument Marking Division, 1415 Park Avenue, Hoboken, NJ 07030.

4.6.2 Test for adhesives. Test for adhesives shall be as shown in Table V.

Table V. Test for Adhesives

Component	Characteristic	Requirement Reference	Test Method
Adhesive	Block shear test	3.2.2	ASTM D 905

Rerun test if the average shear strength of all samples is below 19 300 kPa; there is a 10 percent or greater difference between high and low specimen values, and at least one test specimen broke at more than 19 300 kPa.

Disregard a test specimen in computing the average if it breaks at less than 19 300 kPa; and it has 50 percent or more wood failure.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY.

5.1 Packaging, packing and marking. Package, pack, and mark shipping containers in accordance with the contract or order.

5.2 Special marking. In addition to the requirements required in 5.1 the following should be marked on a minimum of 2 faces of the box in characters a minimum of 50 mm high:

FURNITURE

FRAGILE-HANDLE WITH CARE

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The costumer covered by this specification is designed for use in offices furnished with wood general office furniture.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, symbol, and date of this specification.
b. When preproduction samples are not required.
c. Level of packing and packaging.
d. Marking requirements.

6.3 Known source of supply for tapered connector.

Selby No. 2020 tapered connector or equal
Selby Furniture Hardware Co. Inc.
321 Rider Avenue, Bronx, NY 10451

6.4 SI - English unit equivalents.

1 m^2 (square meter)	= 1.19617 $yard^2$
1 kg/m^3 (kilogram/cubic meter)	= 0.06242 lb.(mass)/ft^3
1 mm(millimeter)	= 0.03937 inch (thickness of one dime)
1 m(meter) = 1 000 mm	= 1.0936 yard (39.37 in)
1 N(Newton)	= 0.225 lb. (force)
1 kg(kilogram)	= 2.2 lb.(mass)
1 g(gram)	= 0.0022 lb. (mass)
1 g(gram)	= 0.03527 oz.(mass avoirdupois)
1 kPa(kilo Pascal)	= 0.14514 lb(force)/in^2(PSI)
(C^o x 9/5) + 32 (Celsius)	= F^o (Fahrenheit)
1 g/m^2 (gram per square meter)	= 0.02949 oz/yd^2 or 0.04426 oz/linear yard (54" W basis

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To convert SI units to English units, multiply SI measurement by the appropriate English conversion factor listed above. See example below:

900 mm X 0.03937 in./mm = 35.43 inches

To convert Celsius temperature to Fahrenheit temperature use the above conversion equation. See example below:

$(20^{o}C \times 1.8) + 32 = 68^{o}F$

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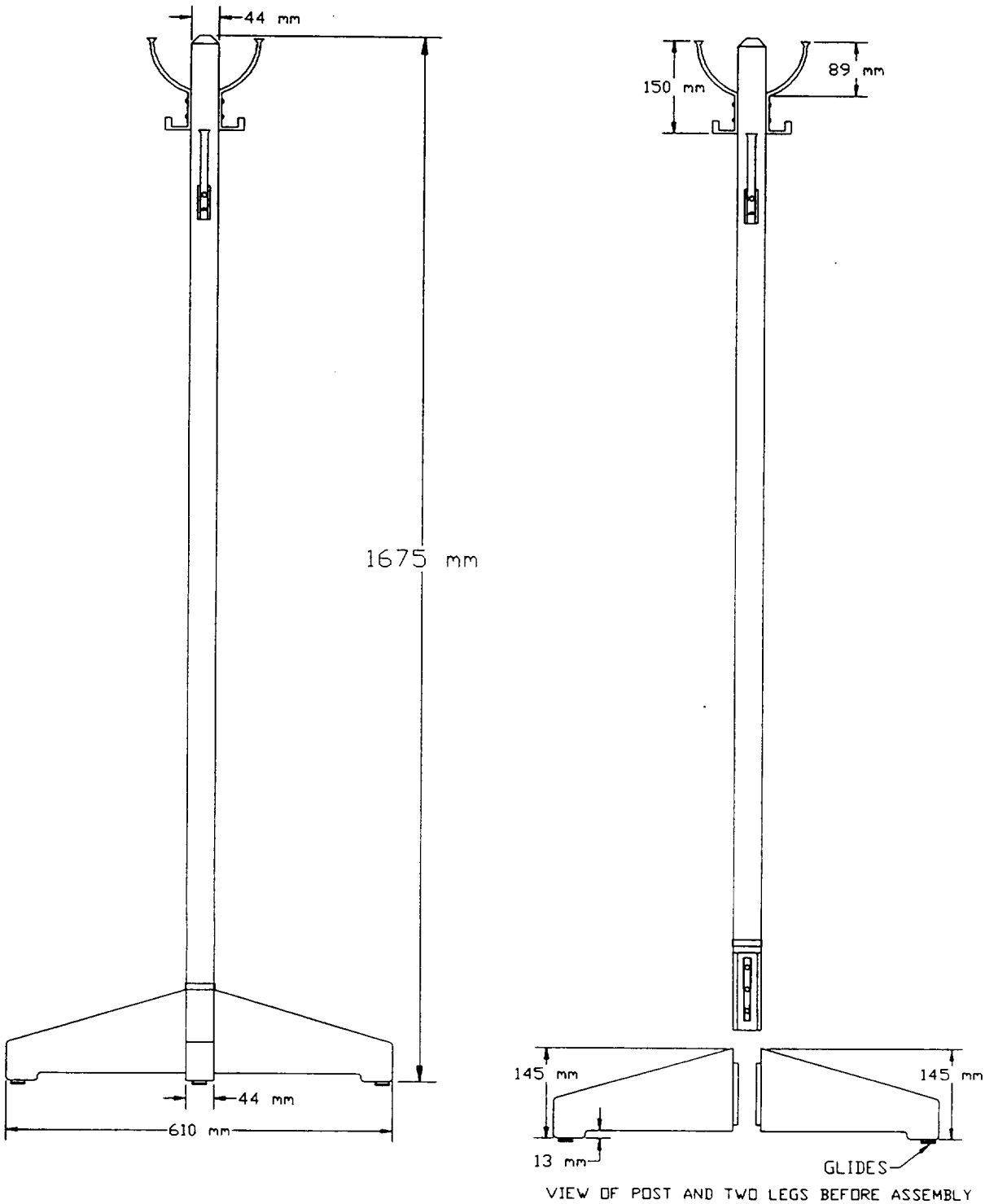


FIGURE 1 COSTUMER

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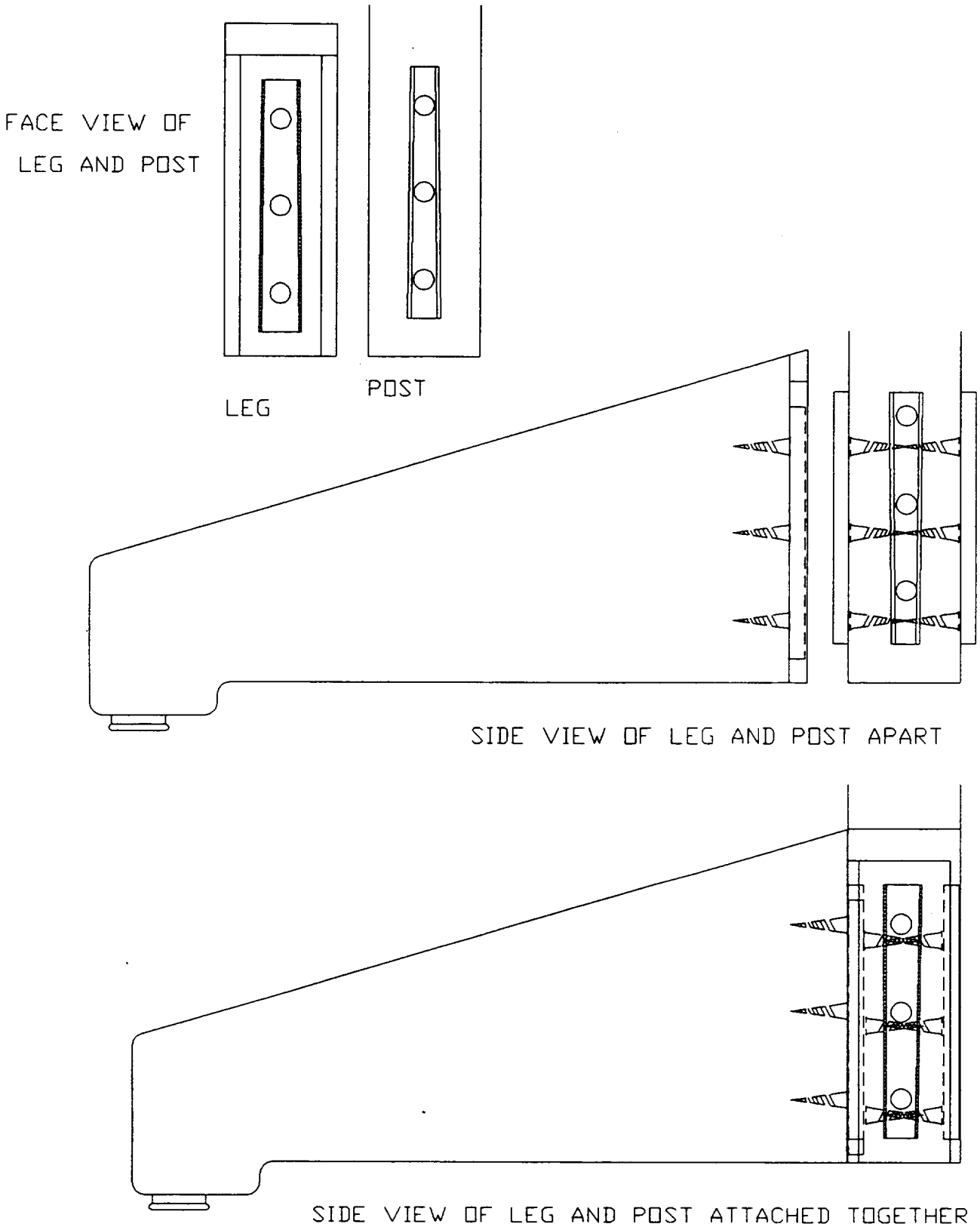


FIGURE 2. COUSTUMER WOOD, GENERAL OFFICE
DETAIL OF LGS AND TAPER CONNECTOR

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